

Cinerific Android App Work Log - September 19, 2026 (U.S. EST)

Compiled summary for Saturday, September 19, 2026 (U.S. Eastern Time) - focus: resuming the post-August-5 Cinerific Android pass by reviewing the current project snapshot and all prior worklogs, restoring the Android Studio and ADB runtime across a standard tablet emulator and native Samsung devices, keeping every authentication route visible and actionable during slide-in states, synchronizing vertical transitions between Create My Account, Sign In, and Forgot Username/Password, restoring the centered chevron row, protecting landscape spacing, resetting stale navigation after each login, correcting title-card hero crops, bounding playback-loading feedback, diagnosing a Figma-derived spinner shadow, replacing the fragile live mask with a clean transparent wheel asset, validating the result on the emulator, Samsung phone, and Galaxy Tab A tablet, committing the two source passes as cc8c036 and b40e734, refreshing the project snapshot, and generating this latest Cinerific PDF worklog artifact.

Generated in continuity with the established Cinerific worklog cadence from July 12, July 14, July 15 Part 1, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, July 23, July 24, July 25, July 27, July 28 Part 1, July 28 Part 2, July 29, August 1, August 3, August 4, and August 5: compact opening summary, source material review, baseline state, goals, themed work completed sections, validation, files touched, follow up context, and output artifact close.

No September 19 Part 1 PDF existed in the repository, so this artifact follows the no-part filename convention for the first September 19 worklog. Eastern Time was verified from the host as Saturday, September 19, 2026 at 8:23 PM EDT, UTC-04:00. The title retains the repository's established U.S. EST label while the body records the seasonally accurate EDT verification. This artifact records the current source state on main through HEAD b40e734, Fixed playback loading visuals and post-login navigation state, plus the refreshed snapshot and generated worklog artifact from this documentation pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Reviewed every pre-existing Cinerific worklog PDF at the repository root: July 12, July 14, July 15 Part 1, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, July 23, July 24, July 25, July 27, July 28 Part 1, July 28 Part 2, July 29, August 1, August 3, August 4, and August 5.
- Converted all twenty prior PDFs with pdftotext and inspected title cadence, summary rhythm, source review language, baseline and goals sections, themed work-completed sections, validation phrasing, file lists, follow-up close, and output-artifact wording.
- Ran pdfinfo and pdffonts across the worklog set, with the closest comparison against August 5, to preserve the four-page U.S. Letter layout, Helvetica body font, PDF 1.4 output, text-extractable structure, title and subject metadata, Codex author/creator/producer fields, and right-aligned page footer convention.
- Ran ./read_project.sh and reviewed the refreshed cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the current source tree, Android source dump, drawable inventory, worklog inventory, generated-file policy, and September 19 timestamp.
- Reviewed git status, git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, and the September 19 commit range from the August 6 worklog commit through HEAD b40e734.
- Reviewed CinerificIntroView.kt, CinerificApp.kt, CinerificDestinationScreen.kt, CinerificLoadingSpinner.kt, the cleaned spinner wheel drawable, .vscode/settings.json, and the regenerated project snapshot.
- Reviewed runtime evidence from the Standard tablet emulator, Samsung SM-G990U phone, and Samsung SM-T580 Galaxy Tab A tablet, including adb discovery, streamed APK installs, activity launches, UI hierarchy dumps, playback-spinner captures, and restored transport-control semantics.
- Reviewed the linked Figma Loading Spinner Animation component set and its six variants, inspected image hashes and node effects through Figma MCP, and compared the original wheel raster with the Android drawable assets.

Baseline Status Before September 19 Work

- Cinerific entered September 19 with the August 5 Create My Account tier dropdown and rotation behavior committed and documented, but no newer root-level PDF worklog.
- The native authentication preview already contained Create My Account, Sign In, and Forgot Username/Password screens, yet inactive route labels did not remain consistently visible or actionable while another slide-in screen was open.
- Switching directly between authentication routes did not yet provide the requested simultaneous vertical exit and entrance behavior.
- Chevron placement and limited landscape height still needed a consistent rule that protected the prompt row and consumed space above the Cinerific logo first.
- Re-entering the main experience after another login could preserve the previous destination, selected title, or catalog route instead of returning to Home.
- Landscape detail heroes for the four Home reel titles could crop away title artwork
- The spinner wheel raster contained semitransparent dark pixels both inside and outside the bright metallic band, producing an unwanted circular shadow over the red star.

- A first runtime clipping approach looked correct on the emulator but caused the white wheel to appear briefly and then disappear on the older SM-T580 tablet GPU.
- Emulator playback was smoother after hardware graphics and resource tuning, but native-device comparison remained important for visual and timing QA.

Main Goals for September 19

- Keep all three authentication route labels visible and tappable regardless of which slide-in screen is active.
- Make route-to-route transitions vertically synchronized and preserve the centered chevron on its own row beneath the links.
- Protect the lower authentication controls in constrained landscape layouts by reclaiming vertical space from above the logo.
- Reset navigation and catalog routing state for every new sign-in session without discarding unrelated favorites or ratings.
- Preserve title text in the landscape hero crops for Light As Air, Infatuation, Into The Wild, and Morbid Temptations.
- Guarantee that playback loading feedback finishes and transport controls return after a short, visible interval.
- Remove the spinner wheel shadow while preserving the original white texture and independent red-star, wheel, and mini-star rotations.
- Validate the same APK across the active emulator and available physical Samsung devices, including the older Galaxy Tab A.
- Refresh the project snapshot and generate the next convention-matched four-page PDF worklog.

Work Completed - Authentication Navigation and Responsive Layout

- Kept Create My Account, Sign In, and Forgot Username/Password labels present across the authentication overlay states instead of hiding the inactive destinations.
- Expanded hit handling so any inactive route label can open its corresponding screen directly from another open authentication screen.
- Reworked route changes into synchronized vertical slide-out and slide-in motion, replacing the briefly introduced horizontal direction with the established vertical behavior.
- Preserved the selected screen transition while keeping the other route labels anchored to their original prompt-row positions.
- Returned the wide downward chevron to one centered location instead of moving it under the selected route.
- Dedicated a separate row beneath the authentication links to the chevron so its visual weight no longer cluttered the route labels.
- Kept the chevron centered independent of the active screen and aligned its touch target with the rendered geometry.
- Adjusted constrained landscape spacing so the layout borrows height from the area above the Cinerific logo rather than compressing the avatar, prompt, or chevron rows.
- Updated the VS Code active-border theme setting during the same committed pass and refreshed the project snapshot.
- Committed the authentication and responsive-layout pass as cc8c036, Refined authentication navigation and responsive layout.

Work Completed - Login Session and Destination Reset

- Added a sign-in session identifier at the root app level and incremented it whenever an avatar/profile completes the authentication handoff.
- Keyed destination, selected program title, catalog genre, and catalog mode saveable state to the new session identifier.
- Ensured a newly authenticated profile enters the default Home experience instead of inheriting stale navigation from the prior session.
- Kept favorites and user ratings outside the session-reset key so the navigation correction did not erase unrelated prototype preferences.
- Applied the same session increment through both the Compose fallback path and native intro-view avatar selection callback.

Work Completed - Detail Hero Cropping and Playback Feedback

- Added title-aware landscape alignment for Light As Air, Infatuation, Into The Wild, and Morbid Temptations so bottom-positioned title artwork remains inside the cropped hero image.
- Preserved the existing top-start alignment for portrait mode and for detail heroes that do not require bottom-title protection.
- Kept ContentScale.Crop in landscape and ContentScale.Fit in portrait, changing only the alignment needed to retain the artwork.
- Added a 900 millisecond playback-loading feedback interval after the Play action.
- Cleared the loading state after the interval and notified the shared playback-session controller that user-initiated playback feedback had finished.

- Restored Favorite, Previous, Play, and Next controls after loading instead of leaving the spinner active indefinitely.
- Confirmed the favorite affordance remained suppressed while the loading overlay was active and returned with the transport controls afterward.

Work Completed - Spinner Asset Diagnosis and Correction

- Inspected CinerificLoadingSpinner.kt and confirmed the Compose implementation only layered and rotated three PNGs; it did not draw a shadow, blur, dark circle, or background.
- Measured the existing wheel PNG and found semitransparent black pixels through the center and outside the bright wheel band, confirming an asset-level artifact.
- Used the linked Figma component set at node 319:6227 to inspect all six animation variants and confirmed every wheel layer reused the same raster image hash with no Figma node effect applied.
- Created a separate corrected Figma component-set copy while preserving the original source component.
- Initially applied an even-odd annular Compose clip to exclude the contaminated center and outer shadow, then tightened the measured mask to the bright metallic wheel band.
- Verified that the tightened mask removed the visible dark circle on the emulator and preserved the textured white ring.
- Diagnosed the SM-T580-only disappearance as a compatibility problem with the rotating runtime clip rather than missing artwork or animation state.
- Generated loading_spinner_wheel_clean.png as a deterministic RGBA derivative of the original wheel, preserving the bright texture while making the center and exterior shadow pixels transparent.
- Replaced the runtime-clipped wheel reference with the cleaned drawable and returned the wheel layer to the same plain graphicsLayer rotation used by the red and mini stars.
- Left loading_spinner_wheel_centered.png intact as the source asset and kept the cleaned derivative as the runtime-safe drawable.

Work Completed - Emulator and Native Device QA

- Tuned the Standard tablet AVD toward hardware graphics, Quick Boot, four CPU cores, three GB of guest RAM, and a 512 MB VM heap while monitoring the M4 Mac's memory pressure and emulator process footprint.
- Distinguished emulator rendering overhead from app-level playback behavior by comparing the same content against physical Samsung hardware.
- Repeatedly built and streamed the debug APK to the active emulator and connected devices without clearing application data.
- Identified the Samsung phone as SM-G990U and avoided treating it as the older tablet after the device inventory was clarified.
- Reconnected and authorized the Galaxy Tab A as SM-T580, serial 52036e1dfc3634eb, then installed and launched the current debug build.
- Captured the corrected spinner on the SM-T580 near the beginning and approximately halfway through its loading interval; the white wheel remained present and visibly rotated.
- Used UI Automator semantics after the interval to confirm Add to favorites, Previous title, Play title, and Next title controls returned on both emulator and tablet paths.
- Verified Cinerific MainActivity was resumed on the native tablet after installation and launch.

Work Completed - Validation, Snapshot, and Commit State

- Ran ./gradlew :app:assembleDebug after the hero, loading-state, and spinner changes; Gradle reported BUILD SUCCESSFUL.
- Ran git diff --check during the source passes and again before documentation generation without whitespace errors.
- Installed the final asset-based spinner APK on the Standard emulator, Samsung phone when connected, and Galaxy Tab A tablet after reconnection.
- Visually compared early and later spinner frames to verify independent rotation and persistent wheel visibility.
- Confirmed the 900 millisecond loading interval returned transport controls instead of leaving an indefinite spinner.
- Committed the playback, navigation-reset, hero-crop, and final spinner asset pass as b40e734, Fixed playback loading visuals and post-login navigation state.
- Refreshed cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt during this worklog pass so the generated project record reflects the current September 19 source and drawable inventory.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Verified host Eastern Time with TZ=America/New_York; the system reported Saturday, September 19, 2026 in EDT at UTC-04:00.
- Used pdftotext on every earlier worklog and pdfinfo on all prior PDFs before generating

this artifact.

- Confirmed all twenty prior worklogs used four U.S. Letter pages and that the recent files used Helvetica, text-extractable PDF 1.4 output, and Codex metadata.
- Reviewed the two September 19 commits, their stats, names, and bodies against the source files they changed.
- Built the debug APK successfully after replacing the live clip with `loading_spinner_wheel_clean.png`.
- Used adb devices -l to distinguish emulator-5554, SM-G990U, and SM-T580 targets as their USB availability changed.
- Used streamed installs, launcher events, activity-state inspection, screen captures, and UI hierarchy dumps to validate the final behavior.
- Confirmed the clean wheel remained visible on the older SM-T580 after rotation advanced, directly addressing the native-tablet-only regression.
- Rendered this generated PDF to PNG pages and inspected the output for clipping, footer placement, page count, and readable density.

Files Touched During September 19

- `.vscode/settings.json`: updated the editor active-border theme setting during the authentication layout pass.
- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificIntroView.kt`: kept all auth route labels actionable, synchronized vertical route transitions, centered the chevron row, and refined constrained landscape positioning.
- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificApp.kt`: added sign-in session tracking and reset destination/program/catalog routing state after each authentication handoff.
- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificDestinationScreen.kt`: preserved bottom title artwork for selected detail heroes and bounded playback loading feedback to 900 milliseconds.
- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificLoadingSpinner.kt`: switched the wheel layer to the cleaned runtime-safe drawable.
- `app/src/main/res/drawable-nodpi/loading_spinner_wheel_clean.png`: added the transparent, shadow-free wheel derivative used across emulator and native hardware.
- `cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`: refreshed the generated snapshot timestamp, source dump, project tree, and asset inventory.
- `cinerific_worklog_september 19.pdf`: added this root-level September 19 worklog using the established no-part naming convention.

Follow-Up Context

- Authentication forms remain prototype UI and are not yet connected to production identity, account creation, password recovery, or the planned backend functions.
- The session identifier intentionally resets navigation state but preserves favorites and ratings; future account-scoped persistence should define those ownership boundaries explicitly.
- The four protected hero titles use title-specific bottom alignment in landscape. New hero artwork with embedded lower titles should be added to the same helper rather than changing every detail image.
- The 900 millisecond loading state is feedback timing, not real media buffering. A future playback backend should replace it with player readiness and error events while retaining a timeout fallback.
- `loading_spinner_wheel_clean.png` should remain the runtime wheel on older Android hardware. Reintroducing a rotating even-odd clip may reproduce the SM-T580 disappearance.
- The original wheel drawable and original Figma spinner component remain available for provenance; the corrected derivative and Figma copy carry the visual fix.
- Device names should be checked with adb devices -l before deployment so the SM-G990U phone and SM-T580 tablet are not conflated.
- The Standard AVD can still render video less smoothly than native hardware because it must emulate the guest display and decode media while Android Studio and other desktop applications are active.

Output Artifact

- Generated `cinerific_worklog_september 19.pdf` at the repository root using the first-log-of-the-day no-part filename convention.
- Preserved the established four-page U.S. Letter layout, Helvetica text, PDF 1.4 compatibility, Codex metadata, right-aligned page footers, and plain-text-readable structure.
- Used the verified September 19, 2026 U.S. Eastern date and documented the host's actual EDT offset while retaining the historical U.S. EST title label.
- The artifact is intended to be committed after review alongside the refreshed `cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` and no additional source changes.